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COMMUNITY CORNER

PARSHAS EMOR אֶמֶר



**SHABBOS
STARTS:** **7:35 PM**
(18 MINUTES)

**SHABBOS
ENDS:** **9:05 PM**
(50 MINUTES)

**TZAIS
HAKOCHAVIM:** **8:58 PM**
(72 MINUTES)

Editor-in-chief: Doni Stern

Made possible by contributing writers throughout our community.

STORY OF THE WEEK By: Zechariah Lipitz

The Maggid of Mezritch (the successor of the Baal Shem Tov) was an unusually gifted Talmudic scholar. But on Shabbat he would only teach spiritual ideas of Chasidism. One Shabbat, however, he unexpectedly gave along and complicated Talmudic dissertation unifying several apparently contradicting legal passages. This was a great wonder to his pupils who nonetheless dutifully memorized every word. The day after that unusual Shabbat, the Maggid told one of his pupils, Rabbi Zusia of Annipoli, to set off on a journey, though the Maggid did not give Reb Zusia a destination. Dutifully, Reb Zusia set off, certain that his feet would take him on the right path. A week later, Reb Zusia stopped for the night at a small inn near the city of Hamburg. "There is one bed available but you can't have it," said the proprietor to Reb Zusia when he inquired about a bed. "The room is being occupied by the great Talmudic genius Rabbi Refoel, and I can't put you together with him." This Rabbi Refoel, a devoted follower of the Vilna Gaon (the undisputed leader of Lithuanian Jewry and one of the biggest opponents of Chasidism), was on his way to Hamburg to vie for the position of Chief Rabbi of that city. Each candidate had to present a Talmudic dissertation before the elder scholars of the city and then answer all their questions satisfactorily; the scholar who found favor in their eyes would be chosen as the next Chief Rabbi. Rabbi Refoel was a sure thing. His genius and erudition were almost unmatched as were his credentials, especially his closeness to the Vilna Gaon. Now he was sitting in this inn repeating the dissertation one last time. It was very long and complex and he wanted to make sure things would go smoothly. Meanwhile, in the lobby, Reb Zusia was trying desperately to convince the owner to just let him have a peek at the great Rabbi Refoel; he felt that this guest had something to do with his mission. Finally the owner agreed. Rabbi Refoel was so deeply involved in his dissertation that he didn't notice Reb Zusia. Reb Zusia, for his part, was startled to hear that the Rabbi was delving into the same exact subject that the Maggid had unexplainably spoken about on Shabbat! Suddenly Rabbi Refoel stopped. He remembered a commentary in the Talmud that completely destroyed his entire presentation! Not only would his dissertation not succeed, it was wrong... he was wrong!! Now Reb Zusia made his presence known and offered his help. Reb Zusia looked like an itinerant beggar and Rabbi Refoel's first instinct was to throw him out. But, he was desperate, so he agreed to listen. "But only on one condition," said Reb Zusia. "The answer I'm giving you now I heard from my master, the Maggid of Mezritch. I want you to promise that after you are chosen tomorrow, you will go to visit him." Rabbi Refoel shuddered. The Maggid? The head of the Chasidim! He hesitated, perhaps the charges against Chasidism were baseless. Rabbi Refoel asked Reb Zusia to proceed. Reb Zusia repeated what he heard from the Maggid solving all Rabbi Refoel's problems. The next day Rabbi Refoel appeared in Hamburg, made a perfect impression and was chosen as Chief Rabbi. But he was afraid to keep his promise. He traveled to Vilna to ask the Gaon what to do. "If you gave your word, you must keep it," he answered. "You must go to the Maggid. But, you must come back immediately and report everything you hear and see. And you must swear before ten men that you won't tell anyone there who you are." Early the next morning Rabbi Refoel dressed like a wanderer and set out. When he arrived at the Maggid's court he was very impressed with what he saw. The prayers and Torah study of the Chasidim had fervor and depth that he had never experienced. And he had never seen anything like the Maggid in his life; here was a G-dly man. Later that morning a woman brought in a chicken with a question as to its kosher status. The Maggid called his pupils over to debate the law. The question was a difficult one, but the Maggid's pupils concluded that the bird was permissible according to all opinions. The Maggid then explained the question according to the Kabbalistic views and also concluded that according to Kabbala the bird was also kosher. Then he added, "But standing right there in the corner is Rabbi Refoel, the Chief Rabbi of Hamburg. Let us hear what he has to say." Rabbi Refoel felt something in his soul open when the Maggid called his name. He looked up in awe and then ran out of the room. But when he returned to the Gaon his newfound respect was not shared. The Gaon gathered ten elders, listened to the rabbi's report and concluded that it was all done through sorcery and evil. "But how do you know that your refusal to speak to the Maggid or consider my report is not from evil?" Rabbi Refoel asked. But he received no reply. Rabbi Refoel did not travel to the Maggid again out of respect for the Gaon. But from that day on, he was no longer an opponent to Chasidism and he eventually became a clandestine Chasid.

MEGA VORT By: Yoel Megadash

Parshas Emor. Perek 24. Pasuk 17-22.

These pesukim talk about the laws for people who kill and injure people or animals. The question is, why are these pesukim put right between the pasuk where Moshe tells Bnei Yisroel to kill the person who cursed Hashem and the last pasuk in the parsha where they actually kill him?

The answer is that the gemara (Makos 7a) says that a court that gives the death penalty even once every seven years is called "destructive".

The gemara (Bava Basra 119a) says the man who cursed Hashem and the man who violated Shabbos in the desert happened at the same time. Since these two people would get the death penalty at the same time the Torah did not want us to take death lightly. Therefore, at this point the Torah stresses the laws of killing and even injuring people or animals. (Birchas Hatzaddik-Rabbi Yitzchok Huberman)



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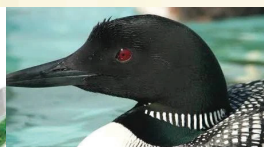
The lesson though, is, that whatever situation G-d puts us in, we cannot cross the line regardless of how bad that situation is.

Freshly cracked black pepper, to taste
1 large loaf of sourdough bread

Start on the bottom of your dish with the olive oil. Add in each item and then mix all together and tear up the Sourdough for dipping. After this you won't need the rest of your meal!



Minnesota



Ask Dr. Hirsch Weekly Q&A with Dr. Shari Hirsch,
Pediatrician and Lactation Specialist at Lev Pediatric Care

Send it to Lev Pediatric Care, and Dr. Hirsch may feature it in an upcoming Q and A.



ANSWER: BECAUSE HE TOOK TOO MANY DAYS OFF!

One who needs to have a cane while walking, is allowed to walk with a cane even where there is not an Eiruv. But if he can walk around without a cane, and he walks around at home without one, but brings one outside just to steady himself, is forbidden. Moreover, one that doesn't need a cane can not walk outside even where there is an Eiruv.

Short Halacha from this week's Kitzur Shulchan Aruch Yomi - Chapter 84 Se'if 5

N	S	B	D	M	M	U	S	S	A	M	U	M	F
B	M	H	M	H	E	A	N	H	I	D	U	R	C
A	Z	E	R	U	H	D	H	S	O	K	E	M	S
K	S	K	S	K	S	A	K	E	S	I	U	M	S
A	A	E	N	O	A	O	Z	D	E	D	E	Z	E
S	M	I	Z	H	H	Z	R	O	I	U	M	Z	M
H	S	K	M	S	L	R	I	K	T	S	A	E	M
A	T	H	A	I	U	K	Z	H	E	H	M	E	S
I	K	H	N	S	L	B	U	A	M	H	H	C	E
I	H	H	I	E	I	I	S	R	I	A	I	M	H
I	S	A	M	F	H	K	H	K	M	S	H	D	I
D	I	A	C	I	C	Z	R	I	O	H	L	I	A
M	A	Z	I	R	R	Z	M	M	S	E	M	D	A
O	I	S	L	A	D	N	S	H	I	M	M	S	H

A map of the community area with a red pin labeled 'COMMUNITY CORNER' indicating the location of the community center. The map shows various streets, green spaces, and a large blue area representing a body of water.

Kehilas Shaar Hashamayim of 71 East Willow Tree Rd (Moshe Brachfeld)



RIBE
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